Andrew W. Shenstone

Shenstone, Andrew - Application for Software Engineer, Frontend Platform @ Bestow

339-223-0797 • shenst1@gmail.com • linkedin.com/in/ashenstone • github.com/shenst1

SUMMARY

Senior engineer with 12+ years of React and production Next.js—server components, typed contracts, and fast pages for real users. Plantfolio is a multi-package monorepo (Turbo, pnpm) where I set patterns, not just features: what we share, how we test, and how deployments stay boring. At Bloom I lived on a GraphQL surface shared across apps; I know how APIs turn into frontend pain when schema and usage are not negotiated early, and I push for shapes and performance decisions that hold at scale. I test with Vitest and Cypress today; Jest, React Testing Library, and Playwright are the same general playbook, and I am happy to align on what your platform team already picked. I lead through pairing and clear code review—no direct reports. I have shipped with CircleCI before, including at Bloom; day-to-day recently is more Vercel-heavy, but pipeline problems are the same work under different logos. Nx is not my everyday monorepo tool—that is the clearer ramp against your posting. I use Cursor as a top 1% user and treat AI as leverage for tests and UI work, not a substitute for judgment.

SKILLS

Frontend platform & SSR: React, Next.js (App Router, Server Components, TypeScript), SSR-minded architecture and production performance, Component architecture, modular boundaries, monorepos (Turbo, pnpm), Accessibility-minded and responsive delivery

GraphQL & APIs: Shipping UIs against GraphQL (Bloom: Rails GraphQL consumed by web and other clients), Schema collaboration, query shape, and performance awareness with backend partners

Testing & quality: Vitest, Cypress, Unit and integration discipline; code review as a teaching tool, Jest / React Testing Library ecosystem: familiar through overlap with

common React stacks

Developer experience & delivery: CI/CD ownership mindset; CircleCI in production at Bloom; recent work often Vercel-forward—same fundamentals (jobs, caching, rollout discipline), Nx: not primary stack today; strong monorepo habits to map across

AI/ML: OpenAI API, AI SDK, Vector Embeddings, Natural Language Processing, Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG)

Cloud & Tools: AWS (S3, EC2), Vercel, Algolia, Inngest, Clerk Auth, Stripe, Git, CircleCI, CI/CD, pnpm, Turbo, Cursor IDE (Top 1% user)

EDUCATION

B.S. Finance, Santa Clara University — 2010

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Lead Engineer

Plantfolio | November 2023 - Present

Product Leadership & Architecture

- Architected and built a comprehensive plant management platform from the ground up, serving as both technical lead and product owner
- Owned the full feature cycle: joined customer calls to identify friction points, architected solutions, implemented, tested, and verified success in production
- Designed and implemented a sophisticated monorepo architecture with 12+ packages, enabling rapid development and maintainable codebases
- Led product strategy and user experience decisions, making product micro-decisions and navigating ambiguity to deliver value iteratively

Technical Achievements

- AI Integration: Built advanced AI-powered features including plant identification from photos, contextual chatbot (Sage), and smart text extraction from plant tags

using OpenAI's vision and language models

- Modern Frontend Architecture: Implemented Next.js with React, React Server Components, and TypeScript, achieving exceptional performance and developer experience
- Complex Data Modeling: Designed and implemented sophisticated PostgreSQL schemas with Prisma, handling complex relationships between users, plants, folios, and media with 15+ interconnected models
- Supabase to Neon: Shipped on Supabase (PostgreSQL with Row-Level Security policies for multi-tenant isolation) before migrating the data layer to Neon; strong hands-on experience with RLS and Postgres-centric access control
- Content Management: Created sophisticated content management system with rich text editing, plant tagging, and flexible data structures

Scale & Performance

- Managed a database of 40,000+ plant species with advanced search capabilities using Algolia and vector embeddings
- Implemented comprehensive media management system with AWS S3, supporting image optimization, galleries, and metadata extraction
- Built robust authentication and authorization systems with Clerk, supporting multiple user types and subscription tiers
- Optimized application performance through React Server Components, efficient data fetching, and strategic caching

Client Case Study - AI Signage

- Delivered a production rollout for an independent garden center to automate plant signage generation; one independent retail customer in ongoing production who has been an enthusiastic reference
- Enabled bulk plant import (plain text) to printable signs in seconds; reduced a weekend-long manual process to minutes after initial setup
- Demonstrated ability to translate customer requirements into scalable technical solutions and shorten feedback loops

Full-Stack Ownership

- Developed complete payment integration with Stripe, subscription management, and user onboarding flows
- Built comprehensive email system with React Email, supporting transactional emails, notifications, and marketing campaigns
- Implemented advanced search and filtering capabilities with Algolia, supporting complex plant queries and user preferences

Code Quality & Leadership

- Established coding standards and architectural patterns that enabled rapid, consistent development
- Implemented comprehensive testing strategy with Vitest and Cypress, maintaining high code quality
- Built reusable component library and design system, ensuring consistent UI/UX across the platform

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Senior Software Engineer

Tilia | January 2023 - August 2023

- Partnered with cross-functional teams in product and design to revamp critical user-facing features
- Built and shipped work in support of KYC, identity verification, and risk-adjacent tooling as part of Tilia's payments platform (tools team context)
- Spearheaded and guided a team through the successful adoption of Chakra UI, reducing bespoke components and establishing cohesive design patterns
- Mentored engineers through pairing and code review in an informal technical lead capacity (no direct reports)
- Maintained exceptional unit test coverage of over 90% for the Tools team application, alongside comprehensive end-to-end testing
- Led the swift creation and deployment of a homepage reporting dashboard within the initial two months of joining

- Role ended in a company-wide layoff affecting approximately one-third of employees

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Senior Software Engineer

Bloom.wine | September 2020 - October 2022

- Architected a greenfield Next.js application for the primary admin interface of the Bloom product; much of that stack remains in production across many winery clients today
- Engineered Ruby on Rails GraphQL API endpoints shared by multiple applications across mobile and web devices
- CI/CD with CircleCI for build, test, and deployment workflows alongside the Next.js and Rails stack
- Mentored engineers through pairing and code review in an informal technical lead capacity (no direct reports)
- Collaborated with designers using Figma, establishing component library standards usable by both engineering and design
- Integrated DatoCMS and extended application functionality through third-party API integrations (Shopify, Mailchimp, Stripe, Shipstation, ActiveCampaign); all Bloom winery clients were on Shopify Plus

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Software Engineer II

Tune Inc - Marketplace Automation | August 2019 - May 2020

- Built and operated ETL-style data pipelines and integrations supporting marketplace automation workflows
- Automated a client workflow using a Node.js/Express API and React.js, reducing the time to complete the task from 10-15 minutes to 10-30 seconds
- Modernized the primary legacy React.js application by moving from a custom Webpack process to react-scripts, resulting in a 50% reduction in production build

size and a 60% reduction in NPM dependencies

- Reduced development machine CPU usage from 75% to <5% by simplifying the build pipeline and dependency graph
- Role ended in a company-wide layoff

Software Developer

Ply Interactive Inc | June 2014 - July 2019

React Native

- Shipped multiple production React Native applications for agency clients—cross-platform mobile apps delivered end to end
- Washington State Fair: React Native app in sustained multi-year production; very high traffic during fair season, from tens of thousands of users into the hundreds of thousands cumulatively over seasons

Web & platforms

- Developed numerous web applications including Georgetownbeer.com, WashingtonWine.org, TwoWolvesWine.com, Novaerus.com, WellAir, and Plasma-air.com
- Built a standalone Ruby gem Content Management System, enabling simplified content management within Ruby on Rails projects
- Transitioned the agency to modern technologies like GraphQL, Gatsby.js, and React.js, improving delivery times for new projects
- Bloom.wine Product Development: Built extensive reporting features using complex PostgreSQL queries and interactive filtering, saving clients thousands of hours on previously manual tasks
- Engineered a flexible Wine Club membership structure for wineries, allowing for diverse client configuration and broadening the range of potential sales targets

- Communicated and enforced the standards of Shopify's Polaris React.js component library with designers, resulting in efficiencies gained from leveraging pre-built components

COMPANY REFERENCE

Plantfolio (2023-Present) - AI-powered plant management platform with 40,000+ plant database serving both consumer garden management and independent garden center services - plantfolio.garden/

Tilia (2023) - All-in-one payment platform for digital economies - tilia.io/

Bloom.wine (2020-2022) - Commerce services for the alcohol industry; all clients on Shopify Plus - bloom.wine/

Tune Inc - Marketplace Automation (2019-2020) - SaaS platform for managing marketing partnerships across mobile and web - tune.com/

Ply Interactive Inc (2014-2019) - Boutique agency: web and production React Native apps (e.g. Washington State Fair at major scale); developed Bloom.wine product internally (2017-2019)